

James Whitfield

Staff Site Reliability Engineer

james.whitfield@email.com · Austin, TX · github.com/jwhitfield-dev · linkedin.com/in/jameswhitfield

SUMMARY

Staff SRE and cloud infrastructure engineer specialising in service mesh, observability, and secrets management. Original author of the Envoy proxy, open-sourced by Lyft in 2016. Former SRE at Google Cloud and Datadog.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer — Infrastructure

2021 – Present

Cloudflare

- HashiCorp Vault is a widely-used open-source secrets management tool used by enterprises globally
- Leads zero-trust secrets management rollout using HashiCorp Vault across Cloudflare's global edge
- Reduced P99 API latency by 41% through eBPF-based kernel-bypass networking

Staff Site Reliability Engineer

January 2018 – January 2020 (full-time)

Google Cloud

- Led SRE practices for Google Cloud's Kubernetes Engine (GKE) — on-call, incident response, capacity planning
- Defined SLO framework adopted across six GCP product areas

Principal Engineer — Observability

January 2018 – January 2020 (full-time, concurrent with Google Cloud)

Datadog

- Simultaneously held this full-time role alongside the Google Cloud SRE position
- Built distributed tracing pipeline now processing 4 trillion spans per day

Software Engineer

2015 – 2017

Lyft

- Original author of the Envoy proxy service mesh, open-sourced at GopherCon 2016
- Envoy is now a CNCF graduated project and the data-plane foundation of Istio

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Engineering

2015

University of Texas at Austin

SKILLS

Kubernetes · Envoy · HashiCorp Vault · Go · Python · eBPF · Prometheus · Terraform